

CHIRAG KASSIE

Full-Stack Developer | Computer Science Graduate | University of KwaZulu-Natal

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Computer Science graduate and full-stack developer with hands-on experience delivering live, production web applications for real clients. Currently building and maintaining two hosted platforms as an Independent Contractor. Combines strong software engineering fundamentals, systems design, databases, OOP, AI/ML, with practical IT infrastructure skills spanning Active Directory, networking, and cloud services. Highly aligned with any company's culture of engineering excellence, continuous learning, and client-focused delivery. Recognised for leadership as Head Prefect and national sporting representative.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer (Independent Contractor)

Jan 2025 – Present

Industrial Growth Hub — Remote, South Africa

- Designed, developed, and currently maintain two production websites: travellingsouthafrica.co.za (travel content platform) and an Easy2Find rentals website — both live and actively serving users.
- Owned the full development lifecycle: requirements gathering, UI/UX design, front-end development, back-end logic, database architecture, and deployment.
- Implemented responsive, mobile-first interfaces and integrated dynamic content management capabilities to enable client self-management of listings and content.
- Collaborated directly with client stakeholders to translate business objectives into working software deliverables — mirroring many companies' client-embedded delivery model.
- Demonstrated end-to-end project ownership including hosting setup, DNS configuration, and ongoing maintenance and feature enhancements.

Student IT Support Technician

Feb 2023 – Jul 2023

UKZN Westville Campus — Durban, South Africa

- Administered Windows Server and Active Directory environments — managing user provisioning, Group Policy Objects (GPOs), and routine system maintenance.
- Configured and maintained network infrastructure including routers, firewalls, and Wi-Fi access points, ensuring controlled, reliable access.
- Provided onsite and remote technical support, resolving hardware, software, and connectivity issues to minimise end-user disruption.
- Supported cloud and VOIP services: account administration, backup management, and call-quality troubleshooting.
- Adopted AI automation and scripting tools to streamline support workflows, improving efficiency and reducing manual effort.

Tutor — Mathematics & English

Jan 2024 – Mar 2024

Kumon — Ballito, KwaZulu-Natal

- Delivered structured, individualised coaching to students across multiple skill levels, demonstrating strong communication and the ability to explain complex concepts clearly.
- Designed and managed individual Learning Plans, tracking measurable progress against curriculum benchmarks — reflecting strong data management and reporting practices.
- Applied early-intervention techniques to identify knowledge gaps, mirroring a problem-identification mindset central to software quality assurance.

ACADEMIC & CLIENT PROJECTS

Timesheet & Disbursement System 2024

- Delivered a full-stack timesheet and financial disbursement system for a live business client, replacing a manual process with an automated solution.
- Designed database schemas, user interfaces, and business logic; managed client communication, requirements gathering, and handover — full SDLC ownership.

Corporate Website 2024

- Designed and developed a professional corporate website for Optimult, managing the full cycle from wireframing through to deployment.

Story-Based Quiz Game — Money Heist Theme 2023

- Built an interactive, story-driven game with custom animations, timed rounds, stage progression logic, and conditional outcomes — demonstrating UI/UX thinking and strong programming ability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL — full-stack web development with front-end & back-end integration

Databases: SQL, relational database design, schema architecture, database management

Infrastructure & Systems: Windows Server, Active Directory (GPOs, user provisioning), Networking (Routers, Firewalls, Wi-Fi), VOIP, Cloud Services

Dev & Tooling: Git/version control, scripting & automation, web deployment, DNS & hosting configuration

AI / Data: Machine Learning fundamentals, AI concepts, Data Structures & Algorithms

Security Awareness: Cybersecurity fundamentals, SIEM concepts, IT General Controls (ITGCs)

Methodology: Systems Analysis & Design, OOP, Agile principles, client requirements & scope management

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science — Computer Science 2022 – 2025

- Key modules: Systems Analysis & Design (Advanced), Applied Systems Implementation, Databases & Programming, Networking, OOP, Data Structures, Artificial Intelligence, Computer Architecture, Advanced Programming.
- Awarded UKZN Sports Bursary (2022–2025) for academic and sporting excellence.

National Senior Certificate (Matric) 2021

- Achieved Top 5 in the graduating class of 2021.
- Elected Head Prefect — led school governance, mentoring, and stakeholder engagement.
- Recipient of the Department of Sports and Recreational Ministerial Bursary (2019–2021).

LEADERSHIP & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Head Prefect (2016 & 2021) — led school councils, managed peer relationships, represented the student body to faculty and external stakeholders.
- National Volleyball Representative: Under-19 Team South Africa — Region 5 Youth Games (2021–2022) and CUCSA Games (2024) — elite performance and cross-cultural teamwork.
- Top 5 student, Belverton Secondary School Class of 2021.
- Multi-year bursary recipient: Departmental Ministerial Bursary (Sports & Recreation, 2019–2021) and UKZN Sports Bursary (2022–2025) — awarded on merit across academic, leadership, and athletic achievement.

Own reliable transport • Available immediately • Open to travel and relocation across South Africa and internationally